

SNAPSHOTS 2023

Accidents in India

	2022	2023
Accidental Deaths	4,30,504	4,44,104
*Rate of Accidental Deaths	31.2	31.9

*Accidental Deaths per lakh population

- ❖ Maximum casualties were reported in age group '30 years– below 45 years' (1,40,933 deaths, 31.7%) followed by the age group '18 years – below 30 years' (1,08,254 deaths, 24.4%) during 2023.

Accidents due to Forces of Nature

- ❖ Total of 6,444 deaths in the country were reported due to causes attributable to forces of nature.
- ❖ Out of 6,444 accidental deaths attributable to forces of nature, 39.7% deaths due to 'Lightning', 12.5% deaths due to 'Heat/Sun Stroke' and 11.4% deaths due to 'Exposure of Cold'.
- ❖ Majority (63.6%) of the victims who died due to accidents caused by forces of nature were reported to be belonging to the age-group of 30-45 years (34.8%) and 45-60 years (28.8%) together.
- ❖ Under 'Lightning', Madhya Pradesh (397), Bihar (345), Odisha (294), Uttar Pradesh (287) and Jharkhand (194) are the biggest victim States/UTs.
- ❖ Total of 602 (9.3%) out of total 6,444 deaths due to causes attributable to forces of nature were reported in 53 mega cities.

Accidents due to Other Causes

- ❖ Under this head are the causes other than Forces of Nature which have resulted in accidents/deaths. They include deliberate or negligent conduct on the part of human beings.
- ❖ Total of 7,30,821 cases were reported in 4,37,660 persons died and 4,53,008 persons injured.
- ❖ Male-Female ratio in fatality during 2023 was –82.2:17.8.
- ❖ The major causes of accidental deaths were (i) 'Traffic Accidents' (45.2%), (ii) 'Sudden Deaths' (see Glossary at the end) (14.5%), (iii) 'Drowning' (8.6%), (iv) 'Falls' (5.7%) (v) 'Poisoning' (5.0%), and (vi) 'Electrocution' (3.2%).
- ❖ Majority (56.2%) of the deaths in 'accidents due to other causes' in the country were in the age group of 30-45 years (31.7%) and 18-30 years (24.5%) together.

- ❖ Total of 7,054 cases of fire accidents were reported in the country during 2023 which rendered 6,891 deaths and injuries to 284 persons.
- ❖ Drowning and Poisoning caused 37,738 (8.6%) and 21,785 (5.0%) deaths respectively during 2023.

Traffic Accidents

- ❖ Total of 4,91,190 'Traffic Accidents' were reported during the year comprising 4,64,029 'Road Accidents', 2,483 'Railway Crossing Accidents' and 24,678 'Railway Accidents'. The traffic accidents caused injuries to 4,51,228 persons and 1,97,871 deaths.
- ❖ The percentage share of deaths in traffic accidents due to 'Road Accidents', 'Railway Accidents' and 'Railway Crossing Accidents' was reported as 87.8% (1,73,826 deaths), 11.0% (21,803 deaths) and 1.2% (2,242 deaths) respectively.
- ❖ It is worth noting that May (44,266) and January (43,544) accounted for maximum number of traffic accidents in the country. As per time period wise analysis, maximum numbers of traffic accidents (1,00,138) were reported during 18:00 hrs to 21:00 hrs in the country.

Road Accidents

- ❖ During 2023, total of 4,64,029 cases of 'Road Accidents' were reported which rendered 4,47,969 persons injured and 1,73,826 deaths.
- ❖ 45.8% victims of road accidents were riders of 'two wheelers' followed by cars, trucks / lorries and three wheeler/auto rickshaw have accounted for 14.3%, 8.0% and 4.1% respectively of road accidental deaths.
- ❖ Majority (61.4%) of road accidents were due to over speeding accounting for 1,01,841 deaths and 2,81,026 persons injured. Dangerous/careless driving or overtaking contributed to 23.7% road accidents which rendered 41,035 deaths and 1,03,306 persons injured and 2.1% of road accidents were due to poor weather conditions.
- ❖ 60.2% and 39.8% of road accidents were reported in rural areas (2,79,572 cases) and urban areas (1,84,457 cases) respectively.
- ❖ 30.6% (1,42,198 cases out of 4,64,029 cases) of total road accidents were reported near residential areas.

Railway Accidents

- ❖ Total of 24,678 cases of railway accidents were reported during the year 2023. These railways accidents rendered 3,014 persons injured and 21,803 deaths.
- ❖ Majority (74.9%) of railways accidents cases were reported under 'Fall from trains / collision with people on track' (18,480 out of 24,678).

Railway Crossing Accidents

- ❖ Total of 2,483 cases of railway crossing accidents were reported which caused 2,242 deaths and 245 persons were injured.
- ❖ Uttar Pradesh has reported the maximum cases of railway crossing accidents (1,025 out of 2,483 cases) accounting for 41.3% of total such accidents.

Suicides in India

	2022	2023
Suicides	1,70,924	1,71,418
*Rate of Suicides	12.4	12.3

*Suicides per lakh population

- ❖ An increase was observed in suicides during 2023 (1,71,418 suicides) as compared to 2022 (1,70,924 suicides).
- ❖ The suicide rate in cities (16.2) was higher as compared to all-India suicide rate (12.3).
- ❖ 'Family Problems (other than marriage related problems)' (31.9%), 'Illness' (19.0%) and 'Drug Abuse/Alcoholic Addiction' (7.0%) have together accounted for 57.9% of total suicides in the country during the year 2023.
- ❖ The overall male : female ratio of suicide victims was 72.8 : 27.2.
- ❖ Nearly 68.1% of the male victims were married whereas the ratio was 64.2% for the female victims.
- ❖ 11.8% victims of suicide were illiterate, 14.8% victims of suicide were educated up to primary level, 18.6% of the suicide victims were educated up to middle level and 24.6% of the suicide victims were educated up to matric level. Only 5.5% of total suicides victims were graduate and above.
- ❖ Suicide by 'Hanging' (60.9%), Consuming 'Poison' (25.0%), 'Drowning' (4.1%) and 'By Coming under Running Vehicles/Trains' (2.8%) were the prominent means of committing suicides.
- ❖ Maximum cases of mass/family suicide were reported from Tamil Nadu (58) followed by Kerala (17), Rajasthan (12), Madhya Pradesh (9) and Andhra Pradesh (8).